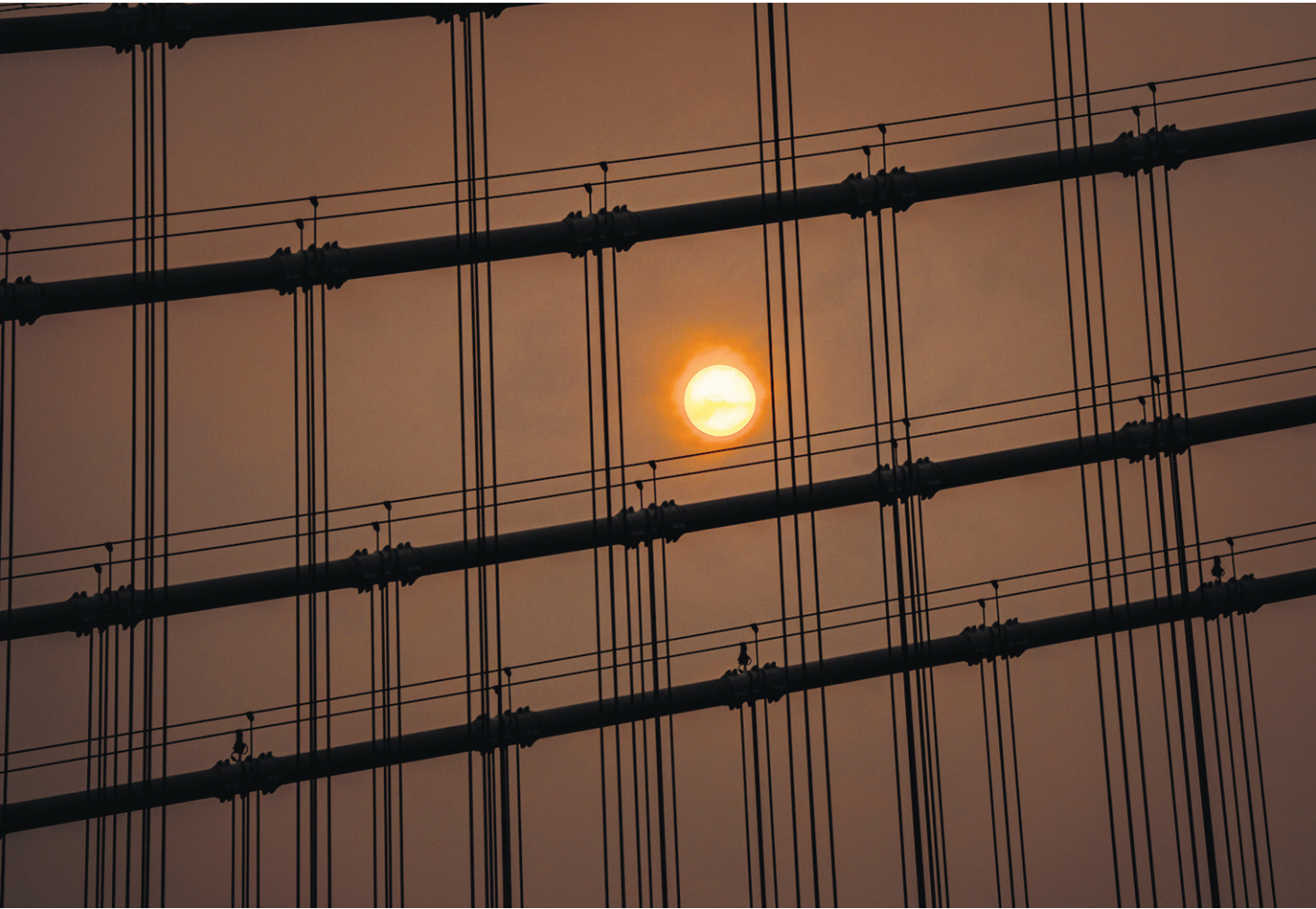




ANGELINA KATSANIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

NEW YORK The Manhattan Bridge on Thursday. The state will provide over 100,000 masks to aid breathing, Gov. Kathy Hochul said.



JAMIE KELTER DAVIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

CHICAGO Along Lake Michigan. As the Air Quality Index topped 300, meaning “hazardous,” the city closed its beaches and pools.



NIC ANTAYA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

DETROIT A runner headed toward the Renaissance Center as wildfires across Ontario created murky conditions to the south.

ICE Ignoring Lesson Taught By Cell Videos

By SHAILA DEWAN and ESMÉ E. DEPREZ

The victims were brandishing a gun, “weaponizing” a car or attacking with a shovel. But these explanations, which federal immigration officials gave for shooting people, were swiftly undercut or contradicted by video evidence.

Now, local officials and some members of the public are meeting the Department of Homeland Security’s accounts of the fatal shootings this month in Houston and Biddeford, Maine, with intense skepticism. In Maine on Monday, an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer killed Joan Sebastian Guerrero, a Colombian living in Biddeford. The department said little more than that he had tried to flee a traffic stop and that an officer, “fearing for public safety,” had fired at him.

Videos that capture the shooting have not surfaced. Maine officials have called for state law enforcement officials to help determine what occurred.

“The people of Maine are not going to buy an investigation that’s strictly run by the F.B.I. or D.H.S.,” Senator Angus King, an independent, told MS Now. “I’m sorry. They just don’t have the credibility.”

The Department of Homeland Security’s terse statements recall a previous era, before bystander video of the police killing of George Floyd in 2020 exposed how misleading the initial version

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Midtown Tower Likely Lacked Required Braces

By JAMES GLANZ and SIMON DUCROQUET

Two columns that buckled and failed in a Midtown Manhattan tower on July 7 were supposed to be strengthened with steel plates to support the addition of 15 residential floors above, according to structural drawings obtained by The New York Times through a records request to the New York City Department of Buildings.

But engineers who examined both the drawings and photographs of the buckled columns said there was no evidence that the plates had been added to the columns as designed. The plates would have turned the columns —

Plan for Work Involved Use of Steel Plates on Two Columns

which had a classic, I-shaped cross-section — into boxlike pillars that would have been easily identified in photographs, the engineers said.

Photographs and videos of the buckled columns gathered by The Times and shared with engineers clearly show two sides of one column and at least one side of the other where reinforcements were required.

The reinforcing plates were critical for supporting the added weight of the new floors, the engineers said, and the drawings left no doubt about the type and location of the new steel. Somehow, though, most or all of the plates appeared to have been left out, leaving the original I-shaped columns more prone to failure. The columns were partly coated with spray-on fireproofing that was also damaged in the buckling process.

Daniel Linzell, a structural engineer and dean of engineering at Worcester Polytechnic Institute, said that the plan detailed in the drawings was clear.

“It refers to and it shows plates

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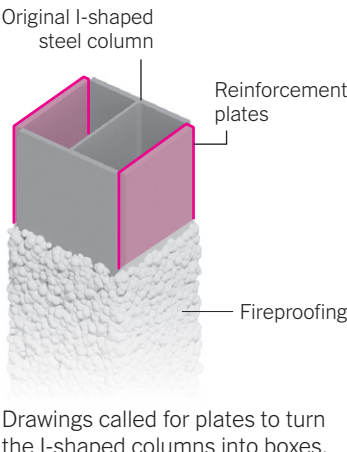
Note: Diagram is illustrative.



THE NEW YORK TIMES; PHOTOGRAPHS FROM NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF BUILDINGS

Drawings Called For Reinforcements

Dotted lines, at left, show where structural plans called for **steel plates** to reinforce the columns, but engineers said the plates were most likely not installed.



Canada’s Fires Shroud States In Perilous Air

Midwest and Northeast Face Acrid Obstacle

This article is by Judson Jones, Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs and Michael Levenson.

Urban skylines vanished in an eye-watering haze. Parks and ball fields that normally fill with dog walkers and joggers were eerily quiet. Some beaches and pools closed. Cars slowed down, as visibility dwindled in the gloomy light of a dull orange sun.

A blanket of dense smoke from Canadian wildfires stretched across Ontario into the Midwest-ern and Northeastern United States on Thursday, disrupting life for millions and prompting many to stay inside with the windows shut.

Others tried to limit the amount of time they spent outside, as air quality readings surged to dangerous levels in Chicago, Cleveland, Detroit, Minneapolis, Toronto and many places in between. The air in cities like Washington, Philadelphia and New York rated only slightly better but was still unhealthy and gray, with the acrid scent of a campfire.

In Chicago, Brandon Olsen, a 35-year-old digital advertising worker, took his dog, Juni, out for a short stroll in Portage Park on Thursday morning but planned to skip their evening walk.

“I walked outside and could feel it in my eyes,” he said. “I was not expecting that. It has a metallic taste and probably isn’t too good of an idea to be out here long.”

In New York City, Robert Vargas felt unsettled as he took his 9-year-son, Aiden, to Soundview Park in the Bronx on Thursday afternoon.

“I’m worried it could mess up his lungs,” Mr. Vargas, 47, a retail store manager, said as his son kicked along on a scooter. “Fire-fighters on Sept. 11 inhaled all that smoke and they started getting sick down the line.”

The bad air was the product of about 800 wildfires burning across Canada, particularly the roughly 180 that have been burning in Ontario, where the fires have prompted air quality warnings, road closures and some evacuations. More than 150 crews and nearly 50 firefighting aircraft were “working around the clock” to extinguish the fires, the premier of Ontario, Doug Ford, said on Thursday.

The smoke spread widely into the United States this week as the same high-pressure system known as a heat dome, which led to brutal heat in the Midwest and the Northeast, trapped the smoke and pushed it close to the ground. By the weekend, as another weather system pushes the hottest air away, the heat and the smoke are expected to ease in the

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ZELENSKY’S FIRING OF DEFENSE CHIEF IGNITES PROTESTS

RIFT OVER INNOVATION

Ousted Drone Advocate Battled Ukraine’s Top Military Leader

This article is by Cassandra Vinograd, Andrew E. Kramer and Oleksandr Chubko.

KHARKIV, Ukraine — Ukraine’s ousted defense minister, Mykhailo Fedorov, issued a fervent defense on Thursday of his efforts to modernize the Ukrainian military and directly attacked the country’s top general as thousands of Ukrainians took to the streets to protest Mr. Fedorov’s dismissal.

At a news conference in Kyiv, the capital, Mr. Fedorov said that he had urged President Volodymyr Zelensky to remove his primary antagonist in the military hierarchy, Oleksandr Syrskiy, the commander in chief, but that the president declined.

Mr. Fedorov, who clashed repeatedly with Mr. Syrskiy while



JEDRZEJ NOWICKI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Mykhailo Fedorov, Ukraine’s ousted defense minister.

championing a high-tech vision of warfare dominated by drones, accused the commander in chief of “blocking all of our initiatives.”

“Instead of figuring out how to defeat Russia asymmetrically,” Mr. Fedorov, 35, said, referring to the drone campaign, Mr. Syrskiy “figured out how to split the country.”

In a social media post, Mr. Syrskiy, 60, did not directly address Mr. Fedorov’s accusations but said the former defense minister’s news conference had been possible only because of the military’s successes in defending Ukraine. “We need to focus on the war and on an effective strategy that is currently demonstrating concrete results,” Mr. Syrskiy wrote, thanking Mr. Fedorov for his service.

Mr. Zelensky acknowledged the rift that had led to the shake-up and the protests, saying he would have preferred unity.

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Before Crash by Pelosi’s Spouse, A Troubled History on the Road

This article is by Livia Albeck-Ripka, Soumya Karlamangla and Shawn Hubler.

LOS ANGELES — In the moneyed vineyards and bistros of Napa Valley, friends had murmured about Paul Pelosi’s health and fitness long before the crash that made him the talk of the town this month.

There had been the attack in 2022 at his home in San Francisco, in which a man looking for Mr. Pelosi’s wife, Representative Nancy Pelosi, the House speaker at the time, had brutally assaulted him with a hammer. There had been the car accident earlier that year as he left the estate of a Democratic donor in nearby Oakville. He pleaded guilty to driving under

the influence after crashing his Porsche into an oncoming Jeep, but friends said at the time that he’d had cataract surgery just days before.

Then, on July 3, under an afternoon sun that dappled the live oaks, Mr. Pelosi slammed his convertible into a parked Tesla, the authorities said, and what had been whispers about his well-being were suddenly all that certain circles here were talking about. And for Mr. Pelosi, 86, the crash appears to have followed a series of driving violations in recent years.

Over more than a decade, he has had at least eight driving violations in the San Francisco Bay Area, including driving the wrong

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

The Ashes of a Revolution

The devastation of Jacqueline Zúñiga’s city in Venezuela follows the demise of her political project. The human ties that help her cope remain.

PAGE A6

For Israel, an Uneasy Limbo

With ongoing U.S.-Iran hostilities creating a constant tension, and Israel on the sidelines, the country is in an uncomfortable place. News Analysis.

PAGE A9

\$2 Million Paid to Trump

A South Korean company that has challenged Commerce Department penalties made a payment to President Trump’s holding company.

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NATIONAL A11-19

Cholesterol Drug Approved

The pills can lower cholesterol levels far below what can be achieved with statins, trials have shown.

PAGE A18

Flooding in Texas Hill Country

A little more than a year after the Camp Mystic tragedy, torrential rain once again soaked Central Texas.

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SPORTS B7-10

Jordan Walker Breaks Out

After all he’s endured, Walker is only 24. The Cardinals star has plenty of time to fulfill his potential.

PAGE B7

Argentina Basks in Starlight

With the team in the World Cup final, fans savor what may be Lionel Messi’s last run in the tournament.

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OBITUARIES A21

A Health Care Innovator

Leonard Abramson created U.S. Health-care and used his great wealth from the sale of the company for causes like advancing cancer research. He was 93.

BUSINESS B1-6

Americans Are Still Spending

Lower gas prices have been a relief for households struggling with costs. But now they are rising again.

PAGE B1

A Factory of Fragrances

Bath & Body Works is seeking its next billion-dollar scent after the success of “Japanese Cherry Blossom.”

PAGE B1



WEEKEND ARTS C1-8

Passion in Every Frame

Christopher Nolan’s love of movies and his commitment to excite an audience pay off in “The Odyssey.”

PAGE C1

Chess Meets Art at MoMA

In honor of Marcel Duchamp, the museum will hold an event where a grandmaster will play on 50 boards.

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OPINION A22-23

Matthew Rose

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